



Development session

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Learning Objectives

By the end of the session, participants will be able to:



1. **Understand** the concept of Instructional Design and its purpose.
2. **Apply** the ROPES and RAR models to design structured learning experiences.
3. **Develop** a simple, effective PowerPoint presentation using basic instructional design principles.

Introduction

Designing effective learning experiences requires more than delivering information it involves understanding how people learn, how to structure content, and how to present ideas in a way that is clear, engaging, and purposeful. Successful learning environments combine **strong instructional design**, thoughtful visual communication, and well-prepared facilitation to ensure that every session has impact and relevance.

you will be introduced to the foundational concepts that shape modern training practices. From understanding the core principles of instructional design, to applying visual design techniques that enhance clarity, to using practical tools that support smooth delivery each section builds toward creating training experiences that are both meaningful and memorable.

Instructional Design serves as the practical **application of the ADDIE model**, transforming each phase into actionable steps that shape effective learning experiences. While ADDIE provides the overall framework—Analysis, Design, Development, Implementation, and Evaluation—Instructional Design brings these stages to life by guiding how content is structured, delivered, and measured in real training environments.

In other words, Instructional Design is the operational engine that turns the ADDIE model from a process into an impactful learning experience



Key Points

Instructional Design is the structured process of planning and creating learning experiences that are **effective, engaging, and measurable**.

Instructional Design Concept

Instructional Design is the systematic process of creating learning experiences that are **effective, engaging, and measurable**.

It involves carefully planning and structuring content so that learners can **achieve specific objectives efficiently**. By following structured stages—such as **analysis, design, development, implementation, and evaluation**—instructional designers ensure that learning is purposeful, clear, and aligned with desired outcomes.



Key Points

Instructional Design is the structured process of planning and creating learning experiences that are effective, engaging, and aligned with clear learning objectives.

Core Content

1. What is Core Content?

Core content is the **essential information** and **key concepts** that support the learning objectives. It focuses on what learners **must understand, practice, or apply**.

2. How to Research Content Effectively

Identify objectives first

- Define what learners need to *know* or *do*.
- Use objectives to filter information.



Use reliable sources

- Academic databases (Google Scholar, ResearchGate)
- Reputable organizations (WHO, UN, PMI, ATD)
- Industry reports & verified publications

Validate information

- Compare multiple sources
- Check publication date

- Ensure source credibility

Collect organized notes

- Summaries, bullet points, definitions
- Highlight key ideas
- Keep references for later

3. How to Write Content

Structure the flow

- Start with a simple **concept introduction**
- Explain using **clear examples**
- Add **practical applications**
- Use **visuals or scenarios** when needed



Prioritize clarity

- Focus on “must-know” information
- Remove unnecessary details
- Use short sentences and direct wording

Align everything with objectives

- Every point should support a learning goal
- Avoid adding content just to fill space

4. Tips for High-Quality Content

- Use **keywords**, not long paragraphs
- Keep tone **clear, neutral, and educational**
- Add **definitions, examples, and mini-summaries**
- Include **evidence-based facts** when relevant



Key Points

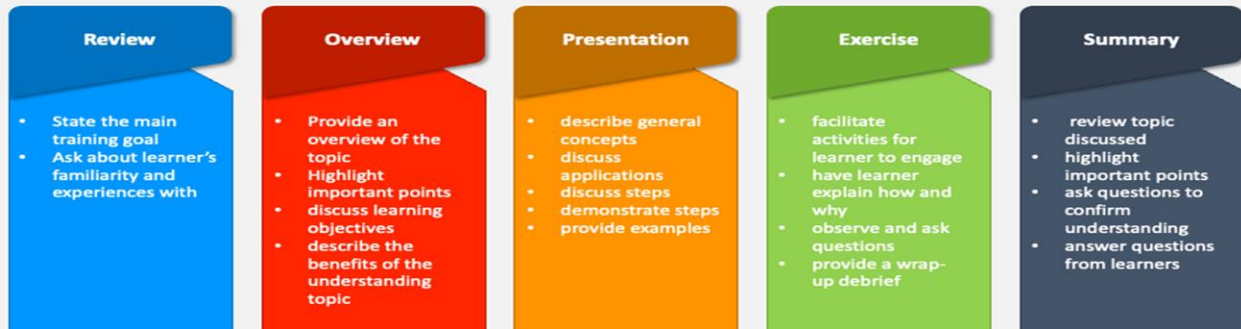
Core content is the essential information that directly supports the learning objectives, and it should be clear, focused, and practical. To create strong content, trainers research reliable sources, filter information based on relevance, and organize it into simple explanations, examples, and key takeaways.

ROPES Model

The **ROPES Model** is a structured framework used in experiential learning and training to design and facilitate effective learning activities. It ensures that learning experiences are **well-organized, reflective, and actionable**. Each letter in ROOPES represents a key step:

ROPES MODEL

Steps and Description



- **R – Results:** Define the intended learning outcomes or objectives for the session.
- **O – Overview:** Provide participants with an introduction or briefing about the activity and its purpose.
- **p – Prepare:** Set up the activity, including materials, instructions, and participant readiness.
- **E – Exercise:** Conduct the activity, allowing participants to engage fully and actively.
- **S – Summary:** Conclude the session by linking the activity back to the learning objectives and key takeaways.



Key Points

The ROOPES model helps to create **structured, interactive, and reflective learning experiences**, ensuring that activities are purposeful and outcomes are achieved.

Types of Activities can be used in Sessions

Activities are essential for creating an engaging and interactive learning environment. They help participants apply concepts, build skills, and stay actively involved throughout the session. Below are common training activities that can be used within any model such as ROPES or RAR, with clear explanations and when to use each.

1. Group Discussion

A guided conversation where participants share ideas, opinions, or experiences related to the topic.

Purpose:

- Encourages critical thinking
- Allows exchange of perspectives
- Builds shared understanding

When to use:

- During *Review* to recall prior knowledge
- During *Presentation* to deepen understanding
- During *Summary* for reflection



2. Role-Play

Participants act out real-life situations or scenarios to practice a skill or behavior.

Purpose:

- Enhances communication and interpersonal skills
- Provides experiential learning
- Improves confidence in real applications

When to use:

- During *Exercise* to practice new behaviors

Examples:

- Delivering feedback
- Handling a customer complaint
- Leading a discussion



3. Case Study

Participants analyze a written or verbal scenario that reflects a real situation.

Purpose:

- Develops problem-solving and decision-making skills
- Applies concepts to realistic contexts



- Encourages group collaboration
- When to use:**
- During *Presentation* for explanation
- During *Exercise* for application

4. Brainstorming

A quick activity where participants generate as many ideas as possible without judgment.

Purpose:

- Promotes creativity
- Activates prior knowledge
- Helps identify learner expectations

When to use:

- During *Overview*
- At the beginning of a new topic



5. Think–Pair–Share

Participants reflect individually, then discuss with a partner, then share with the group.

Purpose:

- Supports quieter learners
- Helps refine ideas before sharing
- Combines individual and group learning

When to use:

- During *Review*
- During *Presentation*



6. Hands-on Practice / Individual Task

Participants perform a specific task on their own to apply a concept directly.

Purpose:

- Develops practical application skills
- Reinforces learning through doing

Examples:

- Designing a slide
- Writing a learning objective
- Creating a process map



7. Group Work / Small-Group Activity

Participants work in small teams to complete a task or solve a problem.

Purpose:

- Builds teamwork
- Encourages varied perspectives
- Produces deeper thinking

When to use:

- During *Exercise*



8. Demonstration

The trainer shows how to perform a task step by step.

Purpose:

- Makes complex tasks easier to understand
- Bridges the gap between theory and practice

When to use:

- During *Presentation*



9. Reflection Activity

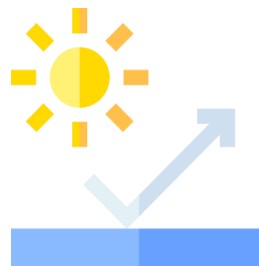
Participants take a moment to think about what they learned and how to apply it.

Purpose:

- Strengthens retention
- Encourages personal commitment

Examples:

- "One thing I learned..."
- Journal notes
- Personal action plan



10. Games & Energizers

Short, fun activities used to boost energy or reinforce learning.

Purpose:

- Increases engagement
- Refreshes concentration

Examples:

- Quick quiz
- Matching cards
- Timed challenges



How to make effective power point?

What Goes on a Presentation?

1. Core Content

- Include only **key words or main points** to keep the content clear and concise.
- Avoid overcrowding slides with full sentences or excessive text.

2. Guidance & Next Steps

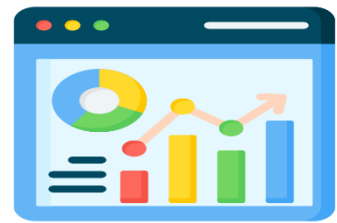
- Clearly present **activity instructions** or directions on the slide.
- Ensure participants understand **what to do next** without confusion.

Tip: A good presentation supports the trainer's explanation rather than replacing it. Slides should **guide and reinforce learning**, not overwhelm learners with information.

Why Visual Design Matter?

Visual design plays a crucial role in learning because it helps participants:

- **Process information quickly and efficiently** – visuals make complex ideas easier to understand.
- **Make connections between concepts** – diagrams, charts, and graphics show relationships clearly.
- **Organize and remember information** – well-designed visuals improve retention.
- **Stay motivated and engaged** – appealing visuals capture attention and maintain interest throughout the session.



Key Points

Good visual design enhances comprehension, memory, and engagement, making learning more effective.

Visual Design Building Unit (Layout)

The **layout** is the foundation of effective visual design in presentations and learning materials.

It determines how content is **arranged, prioritized, and perceived** by learners.



Visual Design Components: Elements and Principles

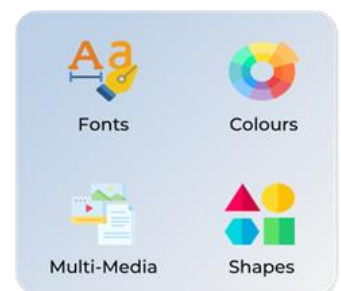
Visual design is built from **elements** and **principles** that work **focus on key information**, understand relationships between concepts, and navigate the material with ease.

together to create effective and appealing learning materials. Understanding these components helps trainers and designers communicate information clearly and engage learners effectively.

1. Elements of Visual Design:

These are the basic building blocks used to create visuals:

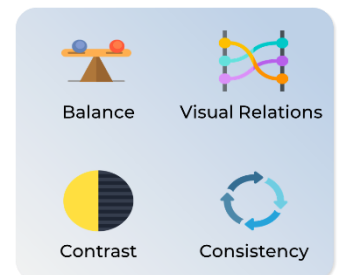
- **Font:** Guides the eye, separates content, and creates structure.
- **Shape:** Adds meaning, emphasis, and visual interest.
- **Color:** Conveys mood, highlights important information, and improves memory.
- **Texture:** Adds depth and tactile feel to visuals.
- **Space (White Space):** Enhances readability and prevents clutter.
- **Typography:** Style, size, and arrangement of text to improve clarity.
- **Images & Graphics:** Support understanding and retention through visuals.



2. Principles of Visual Design:

These are guidelines for arranging elements effectively:

- **Balance:** Distribute visual weight evenly for harmony.
- **Contrast:** Use differences in color, size, or shape to highlight key points.
- **Emphasis:** Draw attention to the most important elements.
- **Alignment:** Organize elements for clean and professional visuals.
- **Repetition/Consistency:** Use recurring styles to unify design and improve recognition.
- **Proximity:** Group related items together to show relationships.



Key Points

Visual design combines basic elements with principles to create clear, appealing, and effective learning materials.

Fonts (Typography)

Typography refers to the **style and appearance of text** in learning materials and presentations. Proper use of fonts enhances readability, emphasizes key points, and contributes to the overall visual appeal.

Key Components of Typography:

1. **Type (Font Style):**
 - Refers to the specific design of the letters, such as **serif** (e.g., Times New Roman) or **sans-serif** (e.g., Arial).
 - Choose fonts that are **easy to read** and appropriate for the context.
2. **Weight:**
 - Indicates the **thickness of the text**, such as light, regular, or bold.
 - Use weight to **highlight important points** or create visual hierarchy.
3. **Spacing:**
 - Refers to the **space between letters (tracking), words, and lines (leading)**.
 - Proper spacing improves **readability and overall clarity** of the text.

Font Hierarchy (Rule of Three)

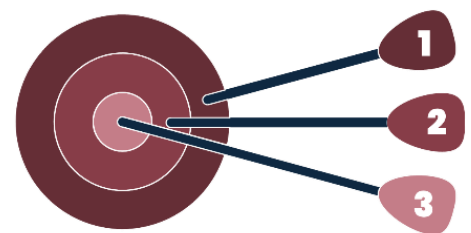
Font hierarchy is the strategic use of different font styles, sizes, or weights to guide the learner's attention and organize information clearly. A clear hierarchy helps participants quickly identify **what is most important** and **how content is structured**.

Rule of Three:

- Limit your design to **three levels of font hierarchy**:
 1. **Heading / Title**: Largest or boldest font to grab attention.
 2. **Subheading / Section Titles**: Slightly smaller or lighter to indicate a secondary level.
 3. **Body / Content Text**: Standard size for main information.

Why it matters:

- Prevents visual clutter.
- Helps learners **scan and understand content efficiently**.
- Creates a **professional and consistent look**.



Colors

Color is a powerful element of visual design that influences **attention, emotion, and comprehension**. When used effectively, it enhances the clarity and impact of learning materials.

Key Principles of Using Color:

- **Purposeful Use:** Choose colors that support the message and highlight key information.
- **Contrast:** Ensure strong contrast between text and background to maintain readability.
- **Consistency:** Use a consistent color palette throughout materials for a unified look.
- **Emotion & Tone:** Colors can evoke emotions—e.g., blue for trust, red for energy, green for growth—so select tones that align with your content’s purpose.
- **Accessibility:** Avoid color combinations that are hard to read or inaccessible for color-blind participants (e.g., red-green combinations).



Multi-Media Items

Multimedia items refer to the combination of different content forms such as text, images, audio, video, and animation to create richer and more interactive learning experiences. When used effectively, multimedia enhances understanding and keeps learners engaged.

Key Principles for Using Multi-media:

- **Relevance:** Every element (image, video, or sound) should directly support the learning objective.
- **Simplicity:** Avoid overloading slides with too many media elements; keep visuals and sounds purposeful.
- **Quality:** Use clear, high-resolution visuals and professional audio for credibility.
- **Balance:** Combine media types thoughtfully to maintain focus and avoid distraction.
- **Accessibility:** Ensure all learners can access the content (e.g., captions for videos, readable text alternatives).

Shapes

Shapes are essential visual elements that help organize information, emphasize key points, and guide the learner’s attention. They can also convey meaning and create visual balance within a design.

Key Principles for Using Shapes:

- **Organization:** Use shapes (boxes, circles, arrows) to group related information and show structure.
- **Emphasis:** Highlight important concepts or data using distinctive shapes or outlines.
- **Direction:** Arrows and flow shapes help illustrate processes or movement.

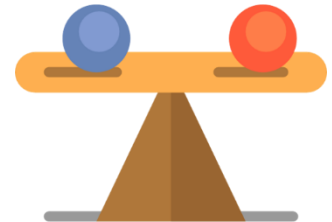
- **Consistency:** Use a consistent shape style throughout materials to maintain a professional look.
- **Simplicity:** Avoid excessive decoration—use shapes purposefully to support clarity and understanding.

Balance

Balance in visual design refers to the **even distribution of visual elements**—such as text, images, and shapes—to create a sense of harmony and stability. A well-balanced layout helps learners focus comfortably and understand content more easily.

Key Principles:

- Avoid overcrowding one side of a slide or page.
- Use alignment and spacing to distribute elements evenly.
- Combine text and visuals thoughtfully to maintain equilibrium.



Visual Relation (Proximity & Alignment)

• Proximity

Proximity means **how close or far** things are from each other in the Slide. When items are close together, we see them as **connected or related**. When they are far apart, we see them as **separate**. Using proximity helps make your slides **clear, organized, and easy to read**.

Key Principles of Proximity:

- Group related things together (Put items that belong to the same idea close to each other).
- Keep space between different groups (Leave enough white space to separate different topics or sections).
- Be consistent (Use the same spacing and alignment across your slides to make them look neat and balanced).
- Guide the viewer's eye (Good spacing helps the audience follow the information in the right order — from the title to the main point to the call to action).

• Alignment

Alignment means arranging visual elements so that they **line up with each other** in a clear and organized way. It helps create order, connection, and structure in a design, making it look neat, professional, and easy to follow. Good alignment makes a layout feel balanced and intentional, while poor alignment can make it look messy or unplanned.

Key Principles of Alignment:

- Creates Order and Structure (Alignment organizes elements visually, helping the viewer understand relationships between them).
- Builds Connection Between Elements (Items that are aligned appear related, creating unity and flow in the design).

- Improves Readability and Balance (Consistent alignment makes text and visuals easier to scan and gives a clean, balanced appearance).

Contrast

Contrast means the **difference between two or more visual elements in a composition**. It's used to create impact, **highlight important information**, and **attract attention**. Contrast helps make your slide interesting, dynamic, and easy to understand by **showing clear differences between elements** such as color, size, shape, or type.

Key Principles of Contrast:

- Creates Visual Interest – Makes your slide **more eye-catching and engaging**.
- Builds **Hierarchy and Focus** – Guides the viewer's eye to the most important parts.
- Adds Meaning Through Differences – The contrast between elements **gives context and clarity**.
- **Improves Readability** – High contrast helps text and visuals stand out clearly.
- Can Be Applied in Many Ways – Contrast can be created using visual or structural differences.
- Brings Balance and Energy – Thoughtful contrast gives the design rhythm and visual flow.

Types of Contrast:

- Contrast in **Color** – Light vs. dark, warm vs. cool, or complementary colors to create focus.
- Contrast in **Size / Scale** – Using big and small elements to show importance or depth.
- Contrast in **Shape** – Mixing geometric and organic shapes, or sharp vs. smooth edges.
- Contrast in **Texture** – Combining rough and smooth surfaces or flat vs. detailed areas.
- Contrast in **Type (Typography)** – Changing font size, weight, color, or alignment to create hierarchy.
- Contrast in **Layout / Position** – Structured vs. free placement, or centered vs. edge-aligned elements.

Consistency

Being consistent in your presentation makes it **look professional, clear, and easy to follow**. Consistency builds **trust, harmony, and visual unity** – it helps your audience focus on your message, not on design distractions.

Key Principles for Consistency:

- Use One Graphical Style

Stick to a **single illustration or icon style** (flat, outline, or hand-drawn). Avoid mixing 2D and 3D images or different visual styles – it looks messy and confusing.

- Use the Same Set of Colors

Choose a **limited, balanced color palette** – ideally your brand colors. Make sure text and background colors have strong contrast for easy reading. Use consistent colors for similar meanings (e.g., one color for highlights or warnings).

- Use One or Two Fonts

Limit your fonts to **one main font** (for titles) and **one secondary font** (for body text). Using too many fonts makes slides look cluttered and unprofessional.

- Do a 5-Minute Design Check

Before finishing your presentation, take a few minutes to check:

- ✓ Fonts are consistent
- ✓ Colors are uniform
- ✓ Graphic style matches across all slides

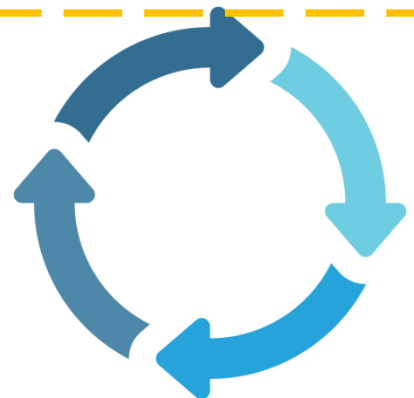


Key Points

Consistency in style, color, and typography makes your presentation look clean, professional, and easy to follow.

Visual Design Resources

- [Coolors](#)
- [Storyset](#)
- [Flaticon](#)
- [Freepik](#)
- [Napkin](#)
- Canva



coolors

storyset

flaticon

Canva

Napkin

freepik

RAR Model Overview

The **RAR Model** is designed to help facilitators focus on the **full experience of each activity** and how it affects learner interaction across activities. It is based on **Experiential Learning Theory and Deep & Active Learning approaches**, emphasizing the learner's personal experience with each activity.

RAR Model Key Principles:

RAR stands for: **Readiness Increase, Activity Facilitation, Reviewing Actively:**

1. Readiness Increase

- Prepares learners to engage fully with the activity.
- Can include mini-presentations, tools, gradual activities, and emotional/mental preparation.
- Ensures learners are in the right state to maximize participation and learning outcomes.

2. Activity Facilitation

- The facilitator motivates and engages learners during the activity.
- Supports learners by moving between groups, listening, clarifying, and assessing.
- Adjusts the activity as needed based on learner profile and experience.

3. Reviewing Actively

- Reflecting, analyzing, and making sense of personal experience.
- Communicating and reframing experiences for deeper understanding.
- Encourages self-expression, improves observation and analytical skills, and reinforces learning outcomes.



Summary & Personal Commitment

This session provided an overview of how to design learning materials that **are clear, structured, and visually engaging**.

Participants explored how instructional design **connects learning objectives with effective visual communication**.

The session highlighted the **importance of simplicity, organization, and balance in every slide or activity**.

It also showed how colors, **fonts, shapes, and layouts work together to create clear and professional** learning materials.

Using models like **ROOPES and RAR** helps trainers plan and review activities effectively, ensuring that learning is interactive and reflective.

Good design supports understanding, maintains attention, and makes learning experiences more enjoyable and meaningful.

Recall

- What is Instructional Design and how does it relate to the ADDIE model?
- How does it ensure learning experiences are effective and measurable?
- How do you research and organize content for a training session?
- What makes training content clear, relevant, and aligned with objectives?
- What are the five stages of the ROPES model?
- How does each stage guide learning and activities?
- What are the key principles for creating clear and engaging slides?
- How can slides support learning without overwhelming participants?
- How does visual design improve comprehension, memory, and motivation?
- What are the main elements and principles of visual design?
- What are the three stages of the RAR model?
- How does it reinforce learning and ensure application?

References

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